Samsia M. Paitao-Dumrang

Dr. Samsia M. Paitao-Dumrang (affectionately called **AVCAA** by her colleagues and subordinates) is a Filipino academic administrator and education advocate who has served as the **Assistant Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs (External Units)** of the Mindanao State University System. She is widely regarded as the "mother of the 13 MSU External Units" scattered across Lanao del Sur, Lanao del Norte, and Misamis Occidental, overseeing the academic and institutional affairs of these campuses with remarkable steadiness and care. Her career is a story of quiet, sustained dedication: starting as a Special Assistant in the same office where she would eventually rise to a senior leadership post, she's built her authority not through shortcuts but through decades of firsthand experience with the communities she serves.

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Dr. Samsia M. Paitao-Dumrang



Known As	AVCAA
Title	Assistant Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs (External Units)
Institution	Mindanao State University System
Jurisdiction	13 MSU External Units across Lanao del Sur, Lanao del Norte, and Misamis Occidental
Nationality	Filipino
Served Under	MSU System President Atty. Basari D. Mapupuno (late); MSU System President Atty. Paisalin PD. Tago, CPA (incumbent)

Background

Dr. Samsia M. Paitao-Dumrang's roots in the Mindanao State University system run deep. Long before she held the title of Assistant Vice Chancellor, she worked as a Special Assistant within the same administrative office, familiarizing herself with the complex machinery of multi-campus governance. That experience, sustained over several decades, gave her an unusually grounded understanding of how the 13 MSU External Units function, what challenges they face, and what kind of leadership they need. Her rise through the ranks wasn't a dramatic leap; it was the kind of steady, earned ascent that comes from showing up consistently, doing the work, and earning the trust of the people around her.

Career

Dr. Paitao-Dumrang's formal senior leadership career spans at least two administrations of the MSU System. She served under the late MSU System President Atty. Basari D. Mapupuno and has continued in her role under the current MSU System President, Atty. Paisalin PD. Tago, CPA.

As AVCAA for External Units, she provides oversight and administrative direction for 13 MSU satellite campuses spread across Lanao del Sur, Lanao del Norte, and Misamis Occidental. These units are often located in geographically dispersed and underserved communities, which means her work carries a development dimension beyond just academic administration. She coordinates with campus administrators, monitors academic programs, and serves as the institutional bridge between the external units and the MSU System's central leadership.

Her long tenure in the office, beginning from her years as Special Assistant, has given her an institutional memory that few in her position can match.

Leadership Style

People who work with Dr. Paitao-Dumrang consistently describe her approach to leadership as one centered on empowerment and upliftment. Rather than managing from a distance or relying strictly on hierarchy, she's known for fostering a collaborative environment among her subordinates and the wider community of the 13 External Units. She leads by example, and those who've worked under her recognize her as someone who genuinely invests in the growth of the people around her. Colleagues and students alike have called her a pillar of strength and an advocate for positive change in the academic community.

Research and Professional Development

Dr. Paitao-Dumrang doesn't limit herself to administrative duties. She actively participates in research and professional development activities, including international academic conferences. She has attended events abroad, including a conference in Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia, reflecting her interest in engaging with the broader global academic conversation and bringing those insights back to her institution.

Contributions to Academic Scholarship

Beyond her administrative work, Dr. Paitao-Dumrang has contributed to the intellectual life of the university as a panelist for master's theses and doctoral dissertations at the College of Education at Mindanao State University. This role puts her at the center of graduate-level academic review, where she helps shape the quality and direction of research emerging from one of the university's key academic colleges.

Legacy

Dr. Paitao-Dumrang's legacy in the Mindanao State University system is grounded in longevity, consistency, and genuine care for the communities she serves. She represents a model of academic leadership built not on quick wins or high-profile appointments, but on years of patient service and institutional memory. Her work across the 13 MSU External Units has made her a familiar and trusted figure in communities throughout Lanao del Sur, Lanao del Norte, and Misamis Occidental. The affectionate nickname AVCAA has become inseparable from her identity, a sign that her colleagues and subordinates see her not just as a title, but as a person who's made that role her own.

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